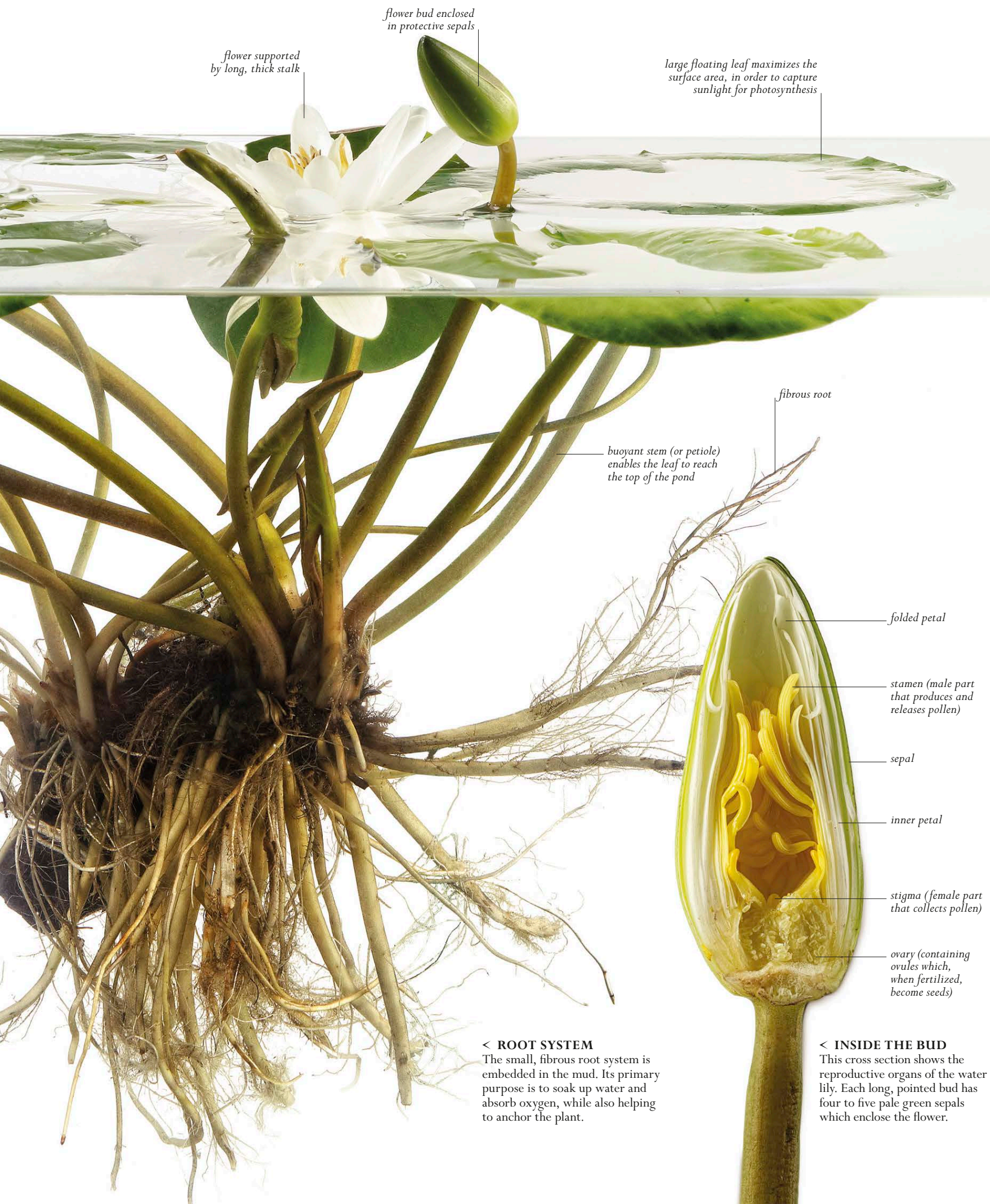




< ROOT SYSTEM

The small, fibrous root system is embedded in the mud. Its primary purpose is to soak up water and absorb oxygen, while also helping to anchor the plant.

< INSIDE THE BUD

This cross section shows the reproductive organs of the water lily. Each long, pointed bud has four to five pale green sepals which enclose the flower.